

ANGEL ACTION · EMERGENCIES

Shock (Hypovolaemic / Circulatory)

Shock is a life-threatening drop in blood flow. Signs include pale, cool, clammy skin, weak rapid pulse, nausea and confusion. Lie the person down, treat the cause, keep them warm and call 000.

Recognise shock

- Pale, cool, clammy skin
- Rapid, weak pulse
- Rapid shallow breathing
- Nausea, thirst, dizziness, confusion
- Restlessness, anxiety or drowsiness
- Eventually collapse and loss of consciousness

What to do

1. **Call 000.**
2. Follow **DRSABCD**.
3. Lie the person down — do **not** raise the legs (current AFA5 guidance).
4. Treat the underlying cause (e.g. control **bleeding**, manage **burns** or **anaphylaxis**).
5. Loosen tight clothing.
6. Keep them warm with a blanket — do **not** apply direct heat.
7. Give small sips of cool water only if they are fully conscious, able to swallow, and have no abdominal injury.
8. If unconscious or having difficulty breathing, place in the **recovery position**.
9. Reassure and stay with the person until help arrives.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*